First, Next, Last

Parent guide: tell a three-step story

Try one story for 5-10 minutes. No child reading is needed.

Read the captions aloud. Let your child point and talk.

No cutting is needed. A pencil is optional for adult notes.

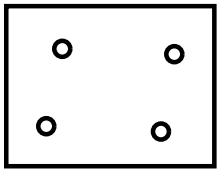
Model together: getting a present ready

In this story, we wrap a box and then add a ribbon.

First

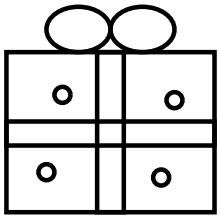
We have a plain box.

Next



We wrap it in spotty paper.

Last



We add a ribbon and a bow.

Say the whole story, using first, next and last.

Ask: "What changed?" Pause and give your child time.

If needed, model the first part and let your child finish.

Accept short phrases, pointing or different clear wording.

On pages 2-3 the pictures are mixed up. Read every caption.

Do one story at a time. No speed or memory test is needed.

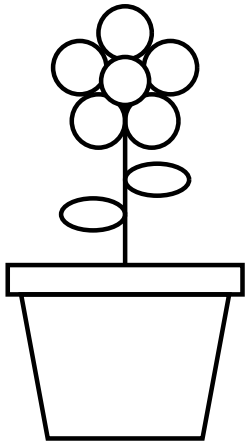
Print pages 2-3 on A4 in black and white. Answers: page 4.

1. From seed to flower

These pictures show one flowering plant as it grows.

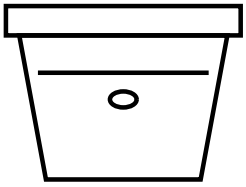
An adult reads the captions. Put the story in order.

A



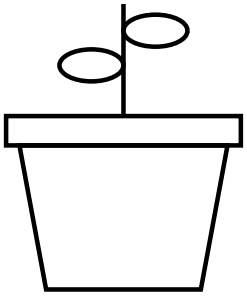
A flower opens on the plant.

B



A seed is planted in the soil.

C



A small shoot grows above the soil.

Point to the pictures in story order. Say:
"First ... Next ... Last ..."

Optional: an adult can write the picture letters.

First: _____ Next: _____ Last: _____

Talk together

What changed between the first and last pictures?

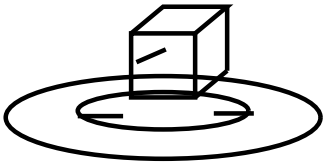
Tell the story again in your own words.

These pictures skip some stages; growing takes time.

2. The melting ice cube

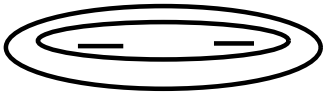
The same ice cube is left on a plate in a warm room.
It melts completely. Put these pictures in story order.

A



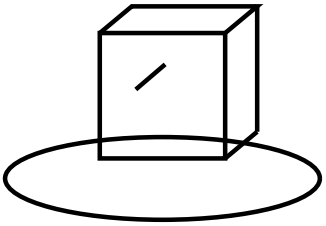
Some ice has melted.
A smaller piece is left.

B



All the ice has melted.
Only water is left.

C



An ice cube is put
on the plate.

Point to the pictures in story order. Say:
"First ... Next ... Last ..."

Optional: an adult can write the picture letters.

First: _____ Next: _____ Last: _____

Talk together

What happened to the piece of ice?

Tell the story again using first, next and last.

This is a picture activity; no ice experiment is needed.

Answers and next steps

Page 2: From seed to flower

Picture order: B, C, A.

First, a seed is planted in the soil.

Next, a small shoot grows above the soil.

Last, a flower opens on the plant.

What changed? Example: a plant grew from the seed and later had a flower.

Page 3: The melting ice cube

Picture order: C, A, B.

First, an ice cube is put on the plate.

Next, some ice melts and a smaller piece is left.

Last, all the ice has melted and only water is left.

What happened? The ice melted into liquid water.

Support a spoken story

These are example sentences, not words to memorise.

Accept different wording that keeps the events in order.

If the order is unclear, reread the captions and compare two pictures together. Ask: "What has changed?"

An adult may write the letters; letter knowledge is not tested.

Next step: retell a familiar short routine together, such as putting on socks, then shoes, then going outside.

Choose a routine that fits your family. No recording is needed.